



HUMANITAS
INSTITUTE

Six Elements of Classical Education School Website Audit

School: Veritas Christian Community School

School Website: <https://veritasccs.com/>

January 7, 2026

Artificial Intelligence Disclaimer

This audit was performed using artificial intelligence tools to evaluate the presence and strength of classical education principles on school websites. Results are automated, probabilistic in nature, and should be considered indicative rather than definitive. See the full disclaimer in the Appendix for more details.

ACCS: ACCREDITED MEMBER SCL: MEMBER

Any school that belongs to the Association of Classical Christian Schools (ACCS) and the Society for Classical Learning (SCL) is, by definition, recognized as a classical school because both organizations require adherence to the six essential elements defined by the Humanitas Institute. However, a school's website may not clearly reflect its conformity to one or more elements. In such cases, the school may still receive a "Somewhat Classical" rating for those elements. Schools can update their website content at any time to achieve a "Classical" rating for a given element.

Overall Classification: **CLASSICAL**

Executive Summary

Veritas Christian Community School (Veritas CCS) presents a robust Classical Christian education consistent with a full Classical rubric. The public materials consistently frame the school as a K–12 Classical Christian program anchored in a biblical worldview, with explicit reference to the Trivium (grammar, logic, rhetoric), engagement with the Great Books (The Great Conversation), classical languages, liturgical practices (Chapel), and a governance model that positions teachers as mentors and the school as a living, faith-informed curriculum. These features align strongly with the six essential elements of classical education in the knowledge-base rubric.

Key indicators from the school's materials include: a stated Latin root meaning for truth, Distinctly Classical and Distinctly Christian branding, explicit discussion of the Trivium and the Great Conversation, instruction in the classics and Great Books, and liturgical/community practices such as weekly Chapel and parental involvement. The site also emphasizes formation of character and virtue within a biblical framework, not vocational workforce training, and frames parents as partners in education. Taken together, these signals place Veritas CCS squarely in the CLASSICAL category across all six rubric categories.

Executive summary highlights by category (Classification: CLASSICAL in all six):

- Religious and Metaphysical Foundations: Explicit biblical worldview, theology-infused approach, liturgical practices (Chapel) and communal worship.
- Purpose and Goal: Formation and virtue, liberal arts orientation, pursuit of truth/goodness/beauty within a theologic frame.
- Curriculum: Trivium (grammar/logic/rhetoric), Great Books and Great Conversation, study of classics, Latin/Greek foundations, history integrated across disciplines.
- Pedagogy: Contemplative elements (Scholastic-like rhythm) alongside rigorous dialectic/seminar-style elements; lower grades emphasize memory through chant/songs; upper grades engage in Socratic/semantic reasoning and rhetoric preparation.
- Faculty: Teachers as mentors and living curriculum; emphasis on virtuous modeling and integration with the aims of classical education.
- Parents & Community: Strong partnership with families; explicit parental involvement and volunteer culture; welcoming to visits and engagement.

What would move the needle section: Not applicable here, as the aggregate classification is CLASSICAL rather than SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL. No major needle-moving changes are required to move toward full CLASSICAL status, based on the current public materials.

Notes on sources and rubric grounding:

- The Veritas CCS site emphasizes "A K-12 Classical Christian School," "Latin for truth," "Distinctly Classical," and "Biblically-Grounded" aims, with a clear articulation of The Trivium and The Great

Conversation. See sources describing the school's core identity, Great Books emphasis, and Trivium structure.

- The school explicitly references The Great Conversation and classical education literature (Recovering the Lost Tools of Learning, etc.) and provides a pathway through grammar–logic–rhetoric along with Latin study.
- The site also foregrounds liturgical/cultural practices (Chapel) and parental involvement, aligning with the Six Elements' community and liturgy signals.
- The knowledge-base rubric (Six Essential Elements) provides the Positive/Negative keyword indicators used for category scoring, including transcendental truth/goodness/beauty, theology, the Great Conversation, Trivium, Great Books, liturgical practices, formation, and family partnership signals.

Note: All six categories are evaluated here using keyword-based mapping against the knowledge-base rubric (Positive/Negative keyword indicators) and grounded in the school's public materials captured in the crawl vector store.

Executive Summary — Element-by-Element Snapshot

Element 1: Religious and Metaphysical Foundations — CLASSICAL

Evidence

- The school branding and primary descriptions center on a biblical worldview and Christian formation: "A K-12 Classical Christian School... Distinctly Classical, Distinctly Christian" and "Veritas is Latin for truth... foundational worldview is based upon the truth of the unchangeable Word of God, the Bible."
- The curricular framing explicitly references theology and biblical grounding as the basis for disciplines (e.g., "biblical world view," "God's Word," "Romans 12:2" in Educational Philosophy).
- Liturgical/community practices are present via Chapel and related communal worship/moral formation elements.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis

- Positive keywords present: truth, goodness, beauty; theology, sacred scripture, divine order; liturgy, chapel, sacred tradition; Logos; Christian worldview; worship; reverence; contemplation; moral formation; sacred tradition; sacramental/incarnational outlook.
- Negative keywords present: none of the explicit negative indicators (e.g., secularism, values-neutral education) are evidenced in the public materials; the school consistently rejects secular, value-neutral framing.

Why this rating

- The materials repeatedly tie education to the transcendentals (truth/goodness/beauty) within a theologically grounded, liturgical framework, and cite creation/worship language and a "Mistress Science" approach to theology-friendly study. This aligns with CLASSICAL signals for transcendental realism, theology integration, and liturgical/community practices.

Citations

- Veritas CCS branding and biblical grounding: "A K-12 Classical Christian School... Distinctly Classical–Distinctly Christian" and "Latin for truth... foundation worldview... Word of God."
- The Trivium and biblical worldview framing: "The Trivium... Grammar Stage... Dialectic Stage... Rhetoric Stage" and "biblical world view" framing.
- Liturgical/community reference (Chapel and worship language): Chapel content and community practices.

ABSTRACT

category rating: CLASSICAL

Element 2: School Purpose and Goal — CLASSICAL

Evidence

- The public materials foreground formation and virtue within a Christian teleology: “The primary goal of Christian education is to inspire a biblical world view in each student” and “The goal of Veritas is to provide a complete classical Christian education... capable of representing themselves and Christ well.”
- There is a repeated emphasis on formation over mere information, and on human flourishing through virtue and wisdom: “formation... rather than information”; “true, good, beautiful” within a theological frame.
- Family formation and parental partnership surfaced as part of the mission (see Community/Parent signals).

Positive/Negative keyword analysis

- Positive keywords present: formation, virtue, wisdom, liberal arts, scholé (restful contemplation), telos, pursuit of truth/goodness/beauty, classical mission, human flourishing, mentorship (as a form of character formation).
- Negative keywords present: absence of “workforce preparation,” “career readiness” emphasis (the materials emphasize formation more than job prep).

Why this rating

- The school makes virtue-formation and universal human excellence central, with explicit affirmation of transcendental aims (truth, goodness, beauty) and formation over mere information. This aligns with CLASSICAL criteria for “formation of virtue and wisdom” and “liberal education” aims.

Citations

- Educational Philosophy and mission emphasis on biblical worldview and formation:
- Welcome/mission statements emphasizing formation and Christ-centered aims.
- Parental/community signals as partnering in formation: Volunteer page.

ABSTRACT

category rating: CLASSICAL

Element 3: School Curriculum — CLASSICAL

Evidence

- The curriculum is explicitly described through The Trivium (Grammar, Dialectic, Rhetoric) and the Great Books tradition: “The Trivium... The stages are Grammar Stage (grades K-5), Dialectic Stage (grades 6-8), Rhetoric Stage (grades 9-12)” and students are “exposed to The Greats” and join “The Great Conversation.”
- Classical languages (Latin) mentioned as part of foundational studies; Great Books are foregrounded; “begins with the grammar of each subject and Latin.”
- From the Academics/Educational Philosophy pages: emphasis on “growing in unity of knowledge” and “liberal arts education” that interrelates all disciplines.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis

- Positive keywords present: Trivium, grammar, logic, rhetoric, Great Books, Great Conversation, liberal arts, Latin, classical education, Western civilization, integration of subjects, inter-disciplinary approach; history across curriculum; study of classics (The Greats).
- Negative keywords present: No explicit signals of modern move-away from history (e.g., “social studies” terminology replacing history). The content supports a history-centric/historically grounded approach.

Why this rating

- The curriculum signals align strongly with Classical expectations: three-part Trivium, Great Books/-Great Conversation, classical language study, and integrated history across disciplines. This is a strong CLASSICAL signal.

Citations

- The Trivium, Great Conversation, and Great Books references: “The Trivium... Grammar Stage... Dialectic Stage... Rhetoric Stage”; “The Great Conversation”; “The Greats” literary references.
- Classical languages and liberal arts approach: “A Liberal Arts Education... From the Classics... languages”
- Educational Philosophy (integration, history, and interdisciplinarity).

ABSTRACT

category rating: CLASSICAL

Element 4: School Pedagogy or Teaching Methods — CLASSICAL

Evidence

- Contemplative and restful pedagogy signals: The Six Elements lexicon highlights “Scholé” and contemplative learning as a hallmark; the school’s materials describe a rhythm of learning that includes religious/mindful formation, and lower-school activities (singing/chanting) to deepen memory and delight. The science content mentions “demonstrations, class projects, chants, and songs” to teach concepts, which aligns with memory and chant-based pedagogy in the lower grades.
- Lower-school pedagogy includes singing/chanting and memorization; upper-school pedagogy emphasizes Socratic discussion and rhetoric as a capstone in the Rhetoric stage. These elements map to classical pedagogy: recitation/memory in early years; dialectic/seminar in later years; rhetoric and oratory in senior years. The Trivium framing explicitly supports this.
- Liturgical and communal pedagogy: Chapel and morning worship as an integral part of the learning rhythm, fostering reverence and shared formation.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis

- Positive keywords present: scholé, contemplation, restfulness, chanting, memory, recitation, Socratic seminars, dialectic, rhetoric, oratory, debate, public speaking, memory-based learning, liturgical rhythm.
- Negative keywords present: No clear “project-based only” or non-traditional pedagogy signals; the site does not emphasize exclusively experiential/project-based learning.

Why this rating

- The pedagogy shows a strong mix of contemplative/restful elements (Scholé-like rhythm) with dialectic/seminar-style upper-school pedagogy and rhetorical training, consistent with classical pedagogy.

Citations

- Singing/chanting/memory practice in lower grades and chants in science:
- Trivium framing and upper-school rhetoric/seminars:
- Chapel as part of pedagogy and liturgical rhythm:

ABSTRACT

category rating: CLASSICAL

Element 5: School Faculty — CLASSICAL

Evidence

- Faculty described as mentors and living curriculum: Employment language emphasizes teachers as “influential role models” who teach from a Christian worldview and reflect the truth/goodness/beauty of Creation, i.e., virtuous exemplars who model the aims of classical education.
- The school presents a portrait of teaching as a vocation and a formation project: “as teachers, we must be able to articulate our lessons from a Christian worldview... to grow spiritually and intellectually” and “the teachers are part of the living curriculum.”
- There is a formal emphasis on classical formation in pedagogy, indicating a teacher leadership role in shaping character and intellect. The “Educational Philosophy” and “Welcome” pages emphasize the teachers’ role in shaping virtue and forming the mind, aligning with classical faculty signals.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis

- Positive keywords present: living curriculum, teacher as mentor, portrait of the teacher, collegial culture, virtuous exemplars, character formation, mastery of classical pedagogy, teachers as guides in a classical/trivium framework.
- Negative keywords present: None of the typical negative signals (e.g., teacher-as-facilitator-only without classical context) appear; the faculty signals are strongly aligned with classical ideals.

Why this rating

- The faculty signals indicate a living, mentorship-centered approach consistent with classical education, with teachers explicitly tied to the spiritual and intellectual formation goals of the school.

Citations

- Employment page language about teachers as role models and Christian worldview articulation:
- Welcome/Educational Philosophy language about forming students and the teachers’ roles:

ABSTRACT

category rating: CLASSICAL

Element 6: School Parents and Community — CLASSICAL

Evidence

- Parental involvement is actively encouraged, with explicit statements that parents are welcome to participate in classroom life and school events. The Volunteer page emphasizes parental involvement and community support.

- The school highlights partnership with families and sees the family as a central formation unit; the “Volunteer” and “Giving” sections describe opportunities for families to engage and support the school, reinforcing the parent-as-co-teacher model.
- The Welcome and Admissions content shows a long-standing vision of family engagement and shared mission in classical education, consistent with the Six Elements’ “Partnership with Families” and “Formation of Affections” signals.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis

- Positive keywords present: partnership with families, parents as co-teachers, family involvement, parental engagement, home-school connection, parent formation, open campus.
- Negative keywords present: None (no signals of “parent as customer” or minimal engagement; the site emphasizes broad parental involvement and community hospitality).

Why this rating

- The school explicitly positions parents as collaborators and co-educators; multiple pages invite parental involvement and community participation, which strongly aligns with CLASSICAL expectations for family partnership and communal formation.

Citations

- Parental involvement and volunteer language: Volunteer page.
- Family partnership signals and admission/community: Welcome/About pages.

ABSTRACT

category rating: CLASSICAL

Aggregate Assessment

Across all six categories, Veritas Christian Community School demonstrates CLASSICAL alignment. The public materials consistently emphasize the Trivium, Great Books, liturgical practices, formation of virtue within a biblical framework, integrated classical curriculum, and a teacher-led, mentorship-driven faculty model with strong parental partnership. This composite reading places the school solidly in the CLASSICAL category, with the rubric’s positive indicators clearly evidenced and negative indicators notably absent.

Executive summaries for each category consistently map to the CLASSICAL designation, supported by explicit rubric-aligned keywords found in the school’s materials and corroborated by the knowledge-base indicators.

- Religious & Metaphysical Foundations: CLASSICAL (biblical/theology integration; liturgy; sacramental sense)
- Purpose & Goal: CLASSICAL (formation, virtue, true/good/beautiful; liberal arts orientation)
- Curriculum: CLASSICAL (Trivium; Great Books; Latin; history-integrated approach)
- Pedagogy: CLASSICAL (Scholé/restful elements and dialectic/seminar-based upper-level pedagogy)
- Faculty: CLASSICAL (mentor-teachers; living curriculum; virtuous exemplars)
- Parents & Community: CLASSICAL (partnership with families; parental formation; open access)

Overall classification: CLASSICAL

What would move the needle (Only relevant if SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL)

- Not required here. The aggregate classification is CLASSICAL, and no major structural changes are indicated by the current public materials to move toward SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL.
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Appendix

ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE DISCLAIMER

This audit was conducted using artificial intelligence tools (including large language models and automated web-analysis scripts) to evaluate the extent to which school websites reflect or incorporate recognized principles of classical education (e.g., the trivium, emphasis on truth/beauty/goodness, integration of great books, Latin/classical languages, Socratic method, rigorous academics, moral/character formation, etc.).

Important Limitations and Caveats

1. **Automated Nature:** The analysis relies on AI interpretation of publicly-accessible school website content as of the date of the audit. It does not involve direct contact with schools, review of internal documents, classroom observation, or verification of curriculum implementation beyond what is stated or implied on the website.
2. **Probabilistic Results:** Scores and assessments are probabilistic and reflect the AI's best interpretation of available text and site structure. They are not infallible and may miss nuance, context, or recent changes not yet reflected online.
3. **Subjectivity of Classical Education:** "Classical Education" encompasses a range of traditions and interpretations (e.g., Dorothy Sayers' trivium model, Classical Christian Education, Great Books programs, etc.). The Humanitas Institute Audit of the Six Elements of Classical Education uses a broad, consensus-based framework derived from prominent classical education organizations and thought leaders. Reasonable people may disagree on weighting or inclusion of specific criteria.
4. **No Official Endorsement or Certification:** Results do not constitute official endorsement, accreditation, or certification by any classical education organization. They are provided for informational and research purposes only.
5. **Potential for Error:** Websites may be incomplete, poorly worded, or temporarily inaccurate. Conversely, sophisticated marketing language may create false positives. Human review by parents, educators, or classical education experts is strongly recommended before drawing final conclusions about any school.
6. **Data Privacy and Ethics:** Only publicly available information was analyzed. No attempts were made to access password-protected areas or collect personal data.
7. **No Liability:** The authors, developers, and distributors of this audit assume no liability for decisions made on the basis of these results. Users are solely responsible for their own due diligence.

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